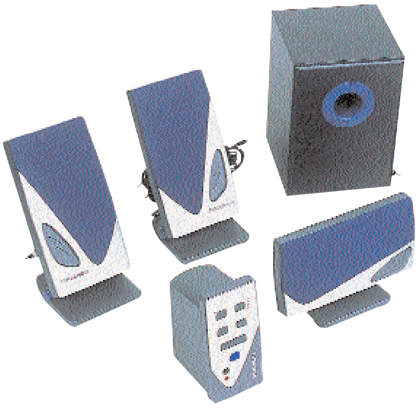

Tornado FP2000: Suffers from too much distortion in sound

**Surround sound**

The speaker that excelled in terms of surround sound was the **Logitech DSR 100.** The punch and clarity of sound that it displayed would keep anybody glued to the movie being played. The surround effect that this speaker system delivers was noteworthy and even the ripped sample files from the DVD (VOB files) that we ran sounded crystal clear. Small creaks and even the sound of the smallest twig cracking under someone's feet were audible.

The Creative DTT2500 comes in a close second. Clarity and depth were some of its prominent features. But the experience that we felt while using the Logitech Xtrusio DSR 100 was definitely missing. However, the surround effect received here was not substantially lesser than the Logitech.

The speaker that came quite close to the Creative DTT2500 was another of Creative's entries, the Creative FPS 1000. This one too, like the DTT2500, sounded complete, but for some distortion that was audible in scenes carrying high pitched sounds. These speaker sets are followed by the Jetway Artis, followed by the Frontech 5D-103 that did well in the surround sound category but lacked the qualities required by a speaker set that would glue movie watchers to their seats. Again, Turando FP2000 fared poorly. The surround effect felt here was good and was comparable to that delivered by the Frontech, but the amount of distortion and cracking heard would easily disturb.

**Features and build quality**

Features, with regard to speaker systems, mean the number of controls present, accessibility to the controls, type of input (analog or digital), number of speakers used, presence of a remote control, etc. Under build quality, we checked out the type of material used to build the speaker, the material used for the cabinet, whether the body vibrates while the speaker is in use, etc.

Starting off with technology, the only speaker sets that supported digital input were the Logitech Xtrusio DSR 100, the Cambridge DTT2500 and the Turando FP2000. The first two came with simple and well-defined connectors that were easy to attach. The Turando FP2000 came with the cables all right, but the main digital input cable seemed quite confusing and it took us a long time figuring out which cable goes where. The cables from the speakers had to be connected to a separate console that had controls to the entire system and an additional wireless remote was also provided to make things easier.

The Logitech Xtrusio came with controls on the subwoofer and a mouse-shaped wired remote control that makes life smooth as far as speakers are concerned. But it was the **Creative Cambridge SoundWorks DTT2500** that stole the show. It is a true digital 5.1 speaker system, equipped as it is with a separate Dolby Digital decoder that allows you to enjoy some stunning DVD audio without purchasing an expensive Dolby Digital system. The only speaker mounting stands that came were those for the rear speakers of Creative's DTT2500 and FPS1000 that helped placing the rear speaker at ear level. This placement enhances the listening experience.

The most innovatively designed speakers were the Turando FP2000. The system was the most jazzy looking flat panel 5.1. Next in line is the Samsung SMS 8320 that sported a cool cone shape. The grille on the Sumoku Logic 2 was a metallic one and not of the usual fabric, but it constantly generated vibrations that actually cost the set a lot in terms of grades as it effected the overall quality of the sound.

The Sumoku Alpha 2 is a good pair to lay your hands on, but its finish left much to be desired. The Logitech DSR had a black dustbin-shaped subwoofer—a break from all those boxy looking subwoofers. The colourful flat panels from Frontech and Jazz Speakers could be the right accessories to add a dash of style to your computer. The worst build quality was seen in the Lexpro LS880. When set to play at high volumes, it started shedding its control buttons.

## Types of Speaker Drivers

A speaker is a device that accepts audio signals from a receiver or amplifier and converts them into sound waves. With the availability of different speakers that cover a different range of frequencies, it is necessary for you to understand what you can expect from the type of speaker that you plan to buy. Generally, speakers are divided into three categories—tweeter, mid range and bass.

**Tweeter:** When a drummer hits the cymbals in his drum set, the high-pitched shrill noise that you hear is produced by this speaker. Unlike the other speakers, the tweeter doesn't have to be large in size and generates frequencies from the upper audio frequency spectrum (from 2,000 Hz or 3,000 Hz to 20,000 Hz).

**Mid-range speakers:** These mainly focus on the vocals and other sounds from different musical instruments. These speakers lie between the bass and treble range in the audio frequency spectrum. These frequencies work from between 150 or 200 Hz to 3,000 Hz. As these speakers cover almost the entire range in the audio frequency spectrum, speaker manufactures generally tend to drive up the power of these speakers and sell them as full range speakers. Full range drivers provide a more consistent sound field than conventional speakers that rely on woofers, tweeters and crossovers.

**Woofers:** The deep punchy sound that one feels when a drummer is playing his set is the bass that is generated by the woofer. They are designed to reproduce only low bass frequencies. A powered subwoofer contains an amplifier and an electronic crossover that helps filter only the lower frequencies that the sub is supposed to handle. These are always the largest speakers seen in a sound setup and for the home segment, they are still the large boxy looking speakers that have to be placed on the floor near any corner of the room. The woofer or the subs as they are generally called, work at the lowest frequency range of the audio spectrum from 20 Hz to 150 or 200 Hz.